

# Dr. Amara Okafor

Research Scientist / Assistant Professor

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Computational biologist with a Ph.D. in Bioinformatics and 30+ peer-reviewed publications (12 as first author, h-index 14). 8 years of experience leading multi-institutional research projects and securing \$4.2M in grant funding.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Research Scientist | Harvard Medical School, Cambridge, MA

2020 - Present

- Lead the single-cell genomics pipeline group; authored 9 papers including 2 in Nature Methods.
- Awarded \$2.1M NIH R01 as co-PI for AI-driven biomarker discovery in oncology.
- Mentor 4 Ph.D. students and 6 postdocs; teach graduate bioinformatics (enrollment 90+/term).

### Postdoctoral Fellow | MIT / Whitehead Institute, Cambridge, MA

2016 - 2020

- Developed an open-source analysis framework used by 200+ labs worldwide (4.8k citations).
- Collaborated on 3 international consortia; presented 12 invited talks at major conferences.

## CORE SKILLS

- Bioinformatics
- Machine Learning
- Statistical Genomics
- Python
- R
- Single-Cell Analysis
- Grant Writing
- Scientific Publishing
- Teaching & Mentoring

## EDUCATION

### Ph.D. in Bioinformatics

University of California, Berkeley • 2016

### B.S. in Biochemistry

University of Lagos • 2011

## SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Okafor A, et al. (2024) "Scalable single-cell integration". Nature Methods.
- Okafor A, et al. (2022) "Deep learning for early cancer detection". Cell Reports Medicine.